

CUSTOMER SUCCESS FRAMEWORK LIBRARY · RETENTION

The Renewal Readiness Score

Renewals are earned long before the renewal conversation

David Maika · Customer Success Strategist | Operations Excellence | AI-Driven Growth

Version 1.0 · Published July 2026

davidmaika.com · linkedin.com/in/davidmaika

The Renewal Readiness Score

Has the customer achieved their desired outcomes?

The single most important question. If the honest answer is no, everything else on this list is secondary -- the renewal conversation should really be a recovery plan in disguise.

Are key stakeholders engaged?

A renewal can look healthy at the champion level and still be at serious risk if the executive sponsor has gone quiet. Engagement has to be checked at every level that influences the decision, not just the level that answers emails fastest.

Is product adoption healthy?

Not just present, but healthy against the specific goals set at the start of the relationship -- a low bar met is not the same as a meaningful one.

Has measurable value been demonstrated?

The same discipline as the Operating System's Step 4 applies here: a felt sense that things are going well is not the same as a number the customer can repeat back to their own leadership.

Are outstanding risks being managed?

An open risk that's actively being worked is very different from one that's been quietly ignored. The Risk Register exists precisely so this question has a documented answer rather than a guess.

Does the customer have confidence in the partnership?

The most holistic question on the list, and often the hardest to score honestly, because it requires being willing to notice a relationship that feels fine on the surface but has lost real confidence underneath.

Copyright Notice

Copyright © 2026 David Maika. All rights reserved.

No part of this publication may be reproduced, distributed, stored in a retrieval system, transmitted in any form or by any means -- electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, or otherwise -- without prior written permission from the copyright holder, except for brief quotations used in reviews, academic work, or other uses permitted under applicable copyright law.

For permissions, collaborations, or licensing inquiries, please contact the author through the website or LinkedIn profile listed on the cover of this publication.

Disclaimer

This publication is intended solely for educational, informational, and professional development purposes.

The concepts, frameworks, templates, examples, and recommendations presented in this guide are based on generally accepted Customer Success, SaaS, business, and operational practices. They should not be interpreted as legal, financial, tax, accounting, or investment advice.

Readers are encouraged to evaluate the applicability of these materials to their own organizations, industries, and regulatory environments before implementation.

While every effort has been made to ensure the accuracy and relevance of the information contained in this publication, the author makes no warranties regarding completeness, accuracy, or suitability for any particular purpose and accepts no liability for any loss or damage arising from the use of this material.

All trademarks, product names, company names, and logos referenced remain the property of their respective owners and are used solely for identification, educational discussion, or illustrative purposes.

About the Author

David Maika is a Customer Success professional with experience spanning customer operations, process improvement, CRM implementation, project management, and business strategy. His work focuses on helping organizations improve customer outcomes, strengthen operational efficiency, and build scalable systems that support long-term growth.

Through practical frameworks, real-world case studies, and modern AI-assisted workflows, he aims to make Customer Success knowledge accessible, actionable, and valuable for professionals at every stage of their careers.

To learn more, access additional resources, or connect professionally, visit davidmaika.com or linkedin.com/in/davidmaika.

Recommended Citation

Maika, D. (2026). The Renewal Readiness Score (Version 1.0). David Maika.